- Additional capabilities—like a central data catalog that utilizes the Confluent schema registry, Trino, and some BI tools—are necessary to enable business analysts to work. This is more straightforward in other setups.

Let's now take a look at the platform itself and then the data products in detail.

8.4.2 Identifying the components

Akin to the Databricks data mesh architecture, this platform interface consists mostly of documentation, and the rest of the interface is the Kafka-specific interface. The team might set up a README file for easy navigation of the company-specific Kafka setup.

The Black team's data product sources data from an upstream SQL-based database, as you can see in figure 8.12. It uses the Kafka Connect built-in JDBC source connector to stream the data into a Kafka topic. ksqlDB is used to transform the data and write datasets into a new Kafka stream as well as into an S3 bucket. For the latter, again a Kafka Connect S3 connector is used. The Kafka stream is accessible via, for example, the Kafka Streams API, or from ksqlDB. Thus the Kafka Streams port becomes the data output port together with the S3 bucket.

